AVIATESAIR

GUIDE

Pilot Guides

Using the AviatesAir Tracker, ACARS and EFB, plus weather and performance know-how.

REVISION	EFFECTIVE	DOCUMENTS	ISSUED BY
0	24 SEP 2026	3	AviatesAir Flight Operations

This copy is uncontrolled once printed or saved. The current revision is always in the AviatesAir EFB (Manuals).
For flight simulation use only. Not for real-world aviation.

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The AviatesAir Tracker & ACARS

Setting up the Tracker (ACARS key, SimBrief, Hoppies), what each page is for, and how a flight is recorded and reported from gate to gate.

The **AviatesAir Tracker** is the desktop app that connects to Microsoft Flight Simulator, records your flights and files your PIREPs. It also hosts the EFB.

First-time setup

1. **Sign in** with your **ACARS key**, the 28-character key you receive when you register at *flyaviatesair.uk*. It identifies you on every PIREP and message.
2. **Settings → SimBrief Integration:** enter your SimBrief username or ID so the Tracker can fetch your OFP.
3. **Settings → Hoppies ACARS:** enable company ACARS messages if you want loadsheets and timing messages in the simulator's datalink. Company messages use AviatesAir's own Hoppies connection, so no personal logon code is needed for them.
4. **Settings → EFB Companion:** enable it to use the tablet (see Guide 2).

The pages

PAGE	USE IT FOR
Dashboard	Today at a glance: your position, booking, recent flights and stats.
Flights	Your logbook: every recorded flight with its landing grade.
Routes	The route network: find routes from your position by type, book, or reposition.
Fleet	The AviatesAir fleet and registrations.
Pilot Hub	Your booking, career statistics and landing history.
ACARS	The live flight: connection state, booking, SimBrief OFP, live flight data, and the Hoppies log.
Map	Live map of your flight and other AviatesAir pilots.
Messages	Direct messages with other pilots (friend codes) and company broadcasts.
News / Events / Support	Company news, events to join, and help.

Flying a recorded flight

1. **Book** on the Routes page. The booking gives you the flight number (**AV…**) and your ATC callsign.
2. Open **ACARS**, generate the plan in SimBrief (the Tracker can open it for you), then **fetch the OFP**.
3. Start the simulator at the gate. The Tracker connects automatically and shows **LIVE**.
4. Fly. The Tracker detects each phase (taxi, takeoff, climb, cruise, descent, approach, landing) and records the route, fuel and your landing.
5. After parking and shutting down, the flight **completes** and the **PIREP is submitted** automatically.

> **CAUTION** Keep the Tracker running from gate to gate. If something crashes, restart the Tracker and simulator. Flight recovery resumes the flight, and a PIREP that failed to send is retried at the next start.

After the flight

- The **touchdown report** pops up after landing, and every landing stays available in the EFB **Landing** app.
- A PIREP flagged by the checks in OM-A 6 is **held for review**. Add a short explanation when you're asked.
- **Discord presence** shows your flight on your Discord profile while you fly (if enabled).

Using the AviatesAir EFB

Pairing a tablet, phone or second screen, and what every EFB app does: dashboard, performance, Pilot Brief, map, checklists, landing report, manuals and more.

The EFB is the AviatesAir tablet. It runs on any device on your home network (iPad, Android tablet, phone or a second monitor) and is fed live by the Tracker.

Pairing

1. In the Tracker, open **Settings** → **EFB Companion** and start the EFB server. Tick "Launch the EFB server when the app starts" to keep it on.
2. On your device (same Wi-Fi network), open the address shown, or scan the QR code.
3. Enter the **6-digit pairing code** if asked. The device stays paired.

> NOTE Add the EFB to your tablet's home screen for a full-screen, app-like experience. On the tablet, swipe up on the home bar or press **Esc** to return to the home screen.

The apps

APP	WHAT IT DOES
AviatesAir	The flight dashboard: route and progress, OOOI times against the schedule, next waypoint and ETA, the vertical profile, live data, fuel and descent advisor, weather, current checklists, last landing.
Departure Perf	Takeoff performance: runway data, FLEX/TOGA, V-speeds, trim and flap (company flap restrictions applied), with the FMS takeoff page to copy.
Arrival Perf	Landing performance: runway condition (RWYCC), autobrake, reversers, failures, VAPP and landing distance.
Map	Moving map with your route, weather radar, SIGMETs, METARs, and VATSIM/IVAO traffic and ATC.
Pilot Brief	Your OFP: flight summary, fuel, weather, NOTAMs, loadsheet and the full plan.
Weather	Weather for your departure, arrival and alternate (or any ICAO you search). Shows the live VATSIM or IVAO ATIS with its letter and frequency, warns you when a new ATIS letter comes out, and lists the controllers online. Below that: the decoded METAR with a wind dial over the runways, the crosswind on every runway, the cloud layers, a TAF timeline with your ETA marked and any SIGMETs over the field. If no ATIS is online, one is built from the METAR.
Checklists	The electronic normal checklist for your booked aircraft (Airbus, Boeing or ATR style).
Landing	Your touchdown report: score, FDM events, approach profile, touchdown zone and stabilised-approach gates.
Manuals	This library: Company NOTAMs, OM-A, OM-B, QRH and guides, with search, bookmarks and PDF export.

APP	WHAT IT DOES
Messages	Chat with other AviatesAir pilots, the same messages as the desktop app. The **Crew Room** goes to every pilot; everything else is one to one. Start a conversation from your pilots, from anyone **flying now**, or with a friend code (yours is at the bottom of the list). **Share my flight** drops your callsign, route, level and ETA into a message. A clock next to your message means it is queued and will go out when the desktop app next reaches the server.
ACARS	Datalink on the Hoppie network, under your own Hoppie logon code. Message company dispatch (VAOPS) or any station, request a pre-departure clearance, get a METAR, TAF or ATIS, and log on to a controller's CPDLC to send requests. Answer uplinks with **WILCO**, **UNABLE** or **STANDBY** on the message screen. Messages still reach your in-sim ACARS too. The **Ops log** shows the automatic company messages.
Settings	Theme, light or dark, **interface size** (Auto makes the EFB bigger on a large monitor), wallpaper, and **Units**: one weight setting, KG or LB, used by every app on every device. **Flight mode** turns alerts, sterile cockpit and keep screen on on or off for this device. Also the EFB-only SimBrief import, ending the flight, your datalink status, the devices connected and the pairing code for adding another.
Scratchpad	Your notepad: pages for the CRAFT clearance, ATIS, takeoff and approach briefs, holding, frequencies and taxi route, plus blank, lined, grid and typed pages. Write with a pen, highlighter or text stamps; values the EFB already knows appear as faint hints. **New flight** starts a fresh set of pages.

Flight mode

The EFB follows your flight by itself:

- **Passing 1,000 ft** on the climb it switches to flight mode. Below **1,000 ft** on the way down it switches to approach mode, and after touchdown it shows **Landed** with a link to your landing report.
- The **dock** at the bottom of the home screen changes with the phase: performance and the brief before departure, the map and weather in flight, checklists and arrival performance on the approach, the landing report after landing.
- **Sterile cockpit**: chat messages are held while you taxi, below 10,000 ft and on the approach. **STERILE** shows in the status bar with the number held, and they appear together once you're clear. ACARS and CPDLC always come through straight away.
- New messages and ACARS uplinks show as a banner at the top when you're in another app. Tap it to open the message.
- The screen stays on during a flight. On a tablet this starts after your next tap.

Manuals app tips

- **Company NOTAMs** marked **READ & ACKNOWLEDGE** show a badge on the home screen until you acknowledge them.
- **Search** covers every manual; tap a result to jump straight to the section.
- Documents for **your aircraft** are pinned at the top of the library automatically.
- **Export PDF** prints the document, or a whole manual, to a PDF you can share.

Weather & Performance Know-How

Reading METARs and TAFs, flight categories, runway condition codes, and what really drives takeoff and landing performance.

Reading a METAR

`EGLL 241150Z 24012G22KT 9999 FEW035 BKN080 12/06 Q1014 TEMPO 4000 SHRA`

GROUP	MEANING
`EGLL 241150Z`	London Heathrow, 24th at 11:50 UTC
`24012G22KT`	Wind from 240° at 12 kt, gusting 22 kt
`9999`	Visibility 10 km or more
`FEW035 BKN080`	Few cloud at 3,500 ft, broken at 8,000 ft (the **ceiling** is the lowest BKN or OVC layer)
`12/06`	Temperature 12 °C, dew point 6 °C
`Q1014`	QNH 1014 hPa (`A2992` = 29.92 inHg)
`TEMPO 4000 SHRA`	Temporarily 4,000 m in rain showers

Flight categories

CATEGORY	CEILING	VISIBILITY
VFR	above 3,000 ft	more than 5 SM (8 km)
MVFR	1,000–3,000 ft	3–5 SM
IFR	500–999 ft	1–3 SM
LIFR	below 500 ft	less than 1 SM

The EFB colours METARs by these categories, and highlights gusts, low ceilings and significant weather.

Reading a TAF

TAFs forecast the weather for 24–30 hours. `BECMG` means a gradual change, `TEMPO` temporary fluctuations (under an hour at a time), `PROB30/40` a 30 or 40 % probability. For planning, the **worst** condition in the arrival window counts (see OM-A 3).

What drives takeoff performance

FACTOR	EFFECT
Weight	Heavier: higher V-speeds and a longer runway needed.

FACTOR	EFFECT
Density altitude (elevation + temperature)	Hot and high: less thrust and lift, a longer takeoff and a lower FLEX temperature.
Wind	Headwind shortens the takeoff, tailwind lengthens it considerably.
Runway condition	Wet or contaminated: longer accelerate-stop distance, lower V1.
Flap	More flap: lower speeds and a shorter run, but worse climb gradient.
Slope	Uphill lengthens the takeoff run.

FLEX / assumed temperature: the aircraft uses less than full thrust, as if it were hotter than it is, when the runway allows. That saves engine wear. EFB Departure Perf finds the highest FLEX temperature that still meets the runway requirement.

What drives landing performance

The landing distance grows with **weight**, **approach speed** (which is why less flap means a longer landing; see CN-003), **tailwind**, **density altitude**, and above all **runway condition**. Braking on a POOR (RWYCC 1) runway can more than double the stopping distance of a dry one. EFB Arrival Perf shows the landing distance for every autobrake setting and warns when the margin is thin. Pick a setting with a comfortable margin, not the one that just fits.